



Mid-Premium phones to get Agentic AI

Christopher Patrick, SVP & GM of Mobile Handsets at Qualcomm is bullish on AI

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In a closed-door media discussion, Christopher Patrick, SVP and General Manager of Handsets at Qualcomm, spoke about the company's plans and explained how the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 is built to raise mobile performances.

The Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 is the first mobile chip to bring Agentic AI to phones. Unlike regular AI that only replies when you ask something, Agentic AI can think ahead, plan, and take action on its own. For example, instead of just showing you flight options, it could actually book tickets, reserve hotels, and even manage cancellations automatically.

To deliver this, Qualcomm has added a new Neural Processing Unit (NPU) and Sensing Hub to the chip. The NPU is 37 per cent faster than the previous version, which means more advanced AI models can run directly on your phone. With on-device learning, the AI adapts to your daily habits, give personalised suggestions.

If there's one area where Patrick believes the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 makes the biggest leap, it's gaming performance.

"That's definitely one of the things we're most proud of on this platform. But there's a lot more. Whatever way you want to use the platform, there's something great for you," he said. Beyond gaming, the Snapdragon 8

Elite Gen 5 is the world's first chip to record in the Advanced Professional Video (APV) codec. Combined with its AI-powered camera features, this enables studio-grade video recording and more flexibility in post-production.

According to Patrick, "If you're a camera enthusiast, this is going to blow you away. Even in tough lighting conditions, you'll get professional-quality results."

As the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 is the premium chip supporting Agentic



AI, we asked if this feature will be limited to premium chipsets or if the company plans to bring it to budget and mid-premium chips very soon.

Patrick replied, "Absolutely. AI, in general, will spread across the entire world. The constraints will be different in mid-tier phones, but even there, we're showing some pretty interesting agentic AI experiences."

Industry experts also shared their views on Patrick's comment about

bringing Agentic AI to mid-tier phones. When asked about how Agentic AI experiences might differ between premium and mid-premium smartphones and whether mid-tier devices could realistically run autonomous AI tasks without major battery or speed compromises, senior industry analyst Mohammad Faisal Ali Kawoosa, Founder at TechArc, said that the experience is likely to be more about how users interact with the AI rather than vast differences in capability.

"I don't expect the Agentic AI experience on premium and mid-premium smartphones to be vastly different. The key difference lies in how users interact with these agents. Premium users are likely to treat these agents as digital secretaries or even a chief of staff, while mid-premium users may use them more like colleagues or buddies," Kawoosa added.

According to Prabhu Ram, VP, Industry Research Group Cyber-Media Research, over time, Agentic AI will reach mid-premium and even lower-tier phones. He believes that smarter chipsets will still handle tasks like adaptive battery management, intelligent scene recognition and voice assistance efficiently. "Using a mix of on-device and cloud processing, mid-tier phones will provide AI experiences that feel proactive, helpful, and increasingly fluid," he added. **d**